

OCS-023 — Constitutional Evidence

Status: Foundational

Authority: Constitutional

Depends on:

- OCS-000 through OCS-022
-

Purpose

This specification defines the constitutional role of Evidence.

Evidence is the constitutional bridge between Observation and Understanding.

Evidence does not determine Truth.

Evidence constrains, supports, challenges, and refines constitutional explanations.

Every constitutional claim SHALL identify its supporting Evidence.

1. Definition

Constitutional Evidence is any attributable constitutional construct that increases or decreases confidence in an Explanation.

Evidence SHALL remain independent from the conclusions derived from it.

Evidence SHALL preserve its constitutional identity.

2. Constitutional Independence

Evidence SHALL remain distinguishable from:

Observation

Interpretation

Explanation

Decision

Action

Understanding

Truth

These constructs MAY reference Evidence.

They SHALL NOT replace it.

3. Evidence Identity

Every Evidence construct SHALL possess:

Identity

Origin

Collection Method

Context

Collection Time

Collector

Integrity Status

Evidence SHALL remain independently referenceable.

4. Evidence Provenance

Every Evidence construct SHALL expose its complete provenance.

Provenance SHALL include:

Origin

Transformation History

Validation History

Dependencies

Known Limitations

Evidence with unknown provenance SHALL remain constitutionally incomplete.

5. Evidence Quality

Evidence quality SHALL be evaluated through:

Observability

Traceability

Reproducibility

Contextual adequacy

Methodological integrity

Internal consistency

Quality SHALL remain explainable.

6. Evidence Strength

Evidence strength SHALL describe constitutional support.

Strength SHALL NOT describe Truth.

Strength MAY evolve through:

Additional observations

Independent validation

Methodological improvement

Discovery of limitations

Strength SHALL remain revisable.

7. Evidence Diversity

Independent evidence strengthens constitutional understanding.

Diversity MAY include:

Independent observers

Independent methods

Independent contexts

Independent implementations

Independent reasoning systems

Evidence diversity SHALL increase constitutional resilience.

8. Contradictory Evidence

Contradictory Evidence SHALL remain constitutional information.

Contradictions SHALL NOT be discarded.

Contradictory Evidence SHALL initiate:

Review

Investigation

Explanation refinement

Methodological evaluation

Contradiction SHALL preserve constitutional history.

9. Missing Evidence

Absence of Evidence SHALL remain distinguishable from Evidence of absence.

Missing Evidence SHALL become an explicit constitutional construct.

Unknown Evidence SHALL remain visible.

10. Evidence Lifecycle

Every Evidence construct SHALL progress through observable constitutional states.

```text id="8m7vpa" Observed

↓

Recorded

↓

Validated

↓

Referenced

↓

Re-evaluated

↓

Historically Preserved ```

Every transition SHALL become constitutional history.

---

## 11. Evidence Preservation

Evidence SHALL preserve:

Original form (when constitutionally possible)

Context

Collection method

Known uncertainty

Historical interpretation

Derived representations SHALL reference original Evidence.

---

## 12. Evidence Interpretation

Evidence SHALL support multiple constitutional interpretations when appropriate.

Interpretation SHALL remain distinguishable from Evidence.

Evidence SHALL NOT silently inherit interpretation.

---

## 13. Evidence Relationships

Evidence MAY support:

Questions

Experiments

Explanations

Predictions

Discoveries

Decisions

Evidence relationships SHALL remain explicit.

---

## 14. Evidence Integrity

Evidence Integrity SHALL require:

Identity preservation

Traceable provenance

Observable collection

Historical continuity

Context preservation

Protection against silent modification

Violation of Evidence Integrity SHALL require constitutional review.

---

## 15. Constitutional Evidence Test

A Constitutional Evidence construct satisfies this specification when an independent investigator can determine:

Where did it originate?

How was it collected?

What does it support?

What are its limitations?

How has it changed over time?

Can it be independently evaluated?

If any answer cannot be reconstructed,

the Evidence is constitutionally incomplete.

---

# Conformance

An implementation conforms to this specification when Evidence remains independently identifiable, attributable, reconstructable, and semantically distinguishable from the interpretations and decisions that reference it.

---

## Constitutional Principle

Evidence is not valuable because it confirms what we believe.

Evidence is valuable because it allows future understanding to become less dependent on belief.

The constitutional role of Evidence is therefore not to defend conclusions,

but to preserve humanity's ability to improve them.

---

**End of Specification OCS-023**